Notes on Sundown Syndrome

Journal of Neuroscience Nursing: February 1990 - Volume 22 - Issue 1 - ppg 51-52

The Relations among Caregiver Stress, "Sundowning" Symptoms, and Cognitive Decline in Alzheimer's Disease

DOI: 10.1111/j.1532-5415.1992.tb01853.x

Conclusion

Sundowning behavior of Alzheimer patients is associated with an increased rate of change of caregivers' perceived stress. This association may be specific to sundowning behavior because there was no relation between the rate of change of perceived stress and morning agitation. The findings suggest that future caregiver intervention programs could profitably focus on sundowning behavior rather than general agitation.

A review of the role of assistive technology for people with dementia in the hours of darkness

Journal: Technology and Health Care, vol. 17, no. 4, pp. 281-304, 2009

DOI: 10.3233/THC-2009-0553

Sundown Syndrome in Institutionalized Elderly

DOI: 10.1111/j.1532-5415.1987.tb01337.x

Flicker adaptation—I. Effect on visual sensitivity to temporal fluctuations of light intensity

https://doi.org/10.1016/0042-6989(71)90214-8

COMMON SUNDOWNING TRIGGERS

- **Too Much End-of-day Activity**: Some researchers believe the flurry of activity toward the end of the day as the facility's staff changes shifts may lead to anxiety and confusion.
- **Fatigue**: End-of-day exhaustion or suddenly the lack of activity after the dinner hour may also be a contributor.
- **Low Light**: As the sun goes down, the quality of available light may diminish and shadows may

increase, making already challenged vision even more challenging.

•**Internal Imbalances**: Some researchers even think that hormone imbalances or possible disruptions in the internal biological clock that regulates cognition between waking and sleeping hours may also be a principle cause.

•**Winter**: In some cases, the onset of winter's shorter days exacerbates sundowning, which indicates the syndrome may have something to do with Seasonal Affective Disorder, a common depression caused by less exposure to natural sunlight.

Seasonal Affective Disorders
https://doi.org/10.3928/0048-5713-19871001-10